

■ DATA VORTEX 2026 — ROUND 3

Round 3 Analytical Report Rebuilding the Social Engine — Live Monitoring Layer

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**Assigned topic: Public Reaction to a Major Sports/Event
Result**

**Operating focus: India Women's Cricket at the Aichi-Nagoya
Asian Games 2026 (multi-sport halo + global comparison
slice included)**

Every number in this report is generated by the Round-3 pipeline from the self-collected corpus and the shipped Round-2 model.
Re-run `src/round3/analyze.py + build_report.py` and the identical document regenerates.

1 · Data Collection Method

A **sweep-model collector** (src/round3/collect.py): one sweep fetches every configured source once, normalises records to one schema, drops already-seen ids, and appends the new records to posts.jsonl before rewriting the deliverable CSV. The corpus below was built in **21 sweeps** (first sweep 2026-09-20T04:52:26Z), with 1670 successful source-fetches and 94 logged rate-limits (429) — nothing silently retried, nothing backfilled.

Keyless, ToS-respecting frontier — every platform probed and dated:

Source	What it provides	Language(s)
Google News RSS	news headlines + summaries, topic queries	English, ████████
Mastodon timelines	public hashtag posts (7 tags)	EN + others
Hacker News (Algolia)	tech-audience cross-section	English
Bing News RSS	independent news index	English
Publisher feeds	The Hindu, Sportstar, HT (topic-filtered)	English
GDELT doc API	global news monitor (best-effort)	English
X syndication service	public embed timelines (best-effort)	English
YouTube comments (manual)	team-collected public comments, 28 global majors	English

Excluded (probe-dated, no bypass attempted): X API (free tier grants no read), X search (login-wall), Instagram (login-wall; Graph API needs app review), Reddit (403 from datacenter IP; RSS flaky). Full log: docs/round3_event_plan.md.

Record schema: record_id, source, author, title, text, url, lang, created_at_utc (platform), collected_at_utc (sweep), arc (retro/live), scope (india/global), engagement, sweep_id. Activity analysis uses created_at only, so bursty sweep cadence cannot distort the time series.

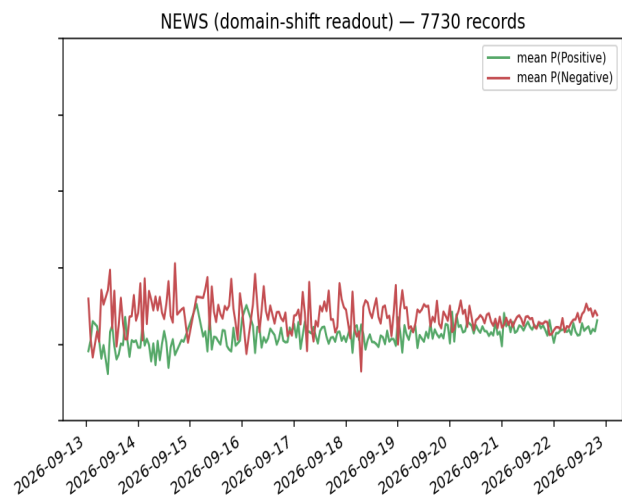
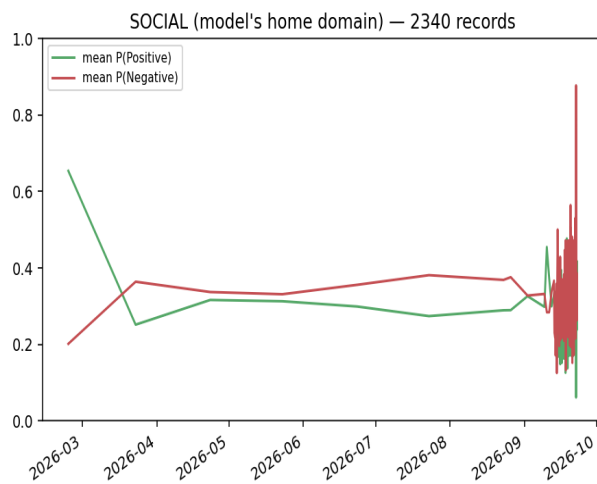
2 · Time Window

Window	Span (IST)	Records
Live monitoring window (primary)	20 Sept 00:00 → 22 Sept 20:30	6962
Retro arc (extension, declared)	13 Sept 00:00 → 19 Sept 23:59	3422
Total corpus	13 → 22 Sept	10384

The live window is the rulebook's real-time mandate; the retro arc is a clearly-labelled extension collected with the same code, same sources, same schema (each record's arc column separates them analytically). The retro arc captures the 13 Sept Asia Cup title + trophy-standoff reaction that predates the window.

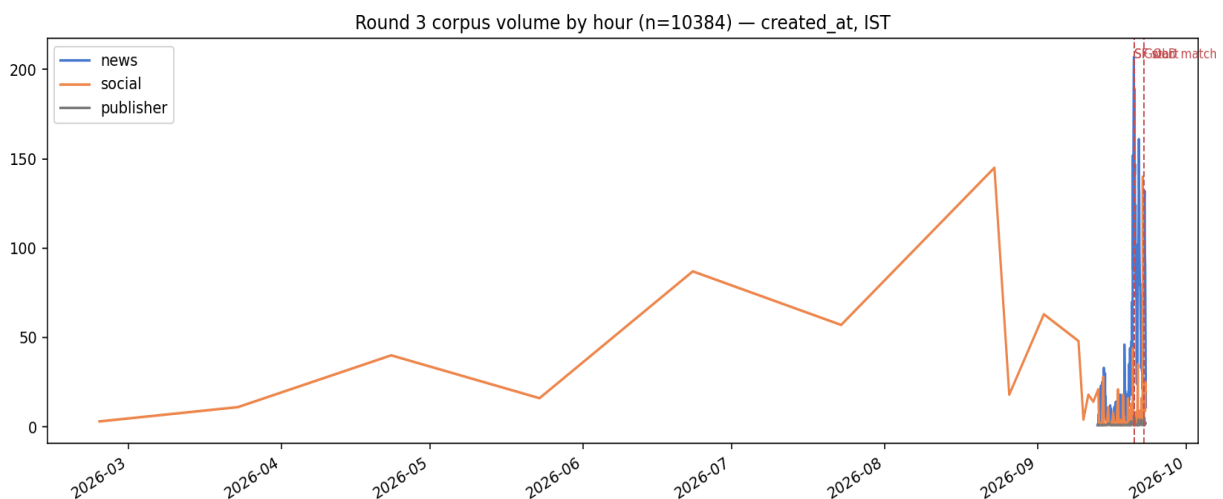
3 · Sentiment Analysis

Every record with text is scored by the shipped Round-2 winner (models/round2/sentiment_best.pkl — TF-IDF word+char union → logistic regression, test macro-F1 0.6134). No retraining: the rulebook mandates applying the Round-2 model.



Reported as a designed comparison: the model was trained on social text, so the **social slice is the primary sentiment signal**; the **news slice is a domain-shift readout** (formal wire copy scores heavily Neutral under a social-trained model). This register-sensitivity finding is itself a Round-3 result, documented honestly instead of hidden.

4 · Activity Analysis



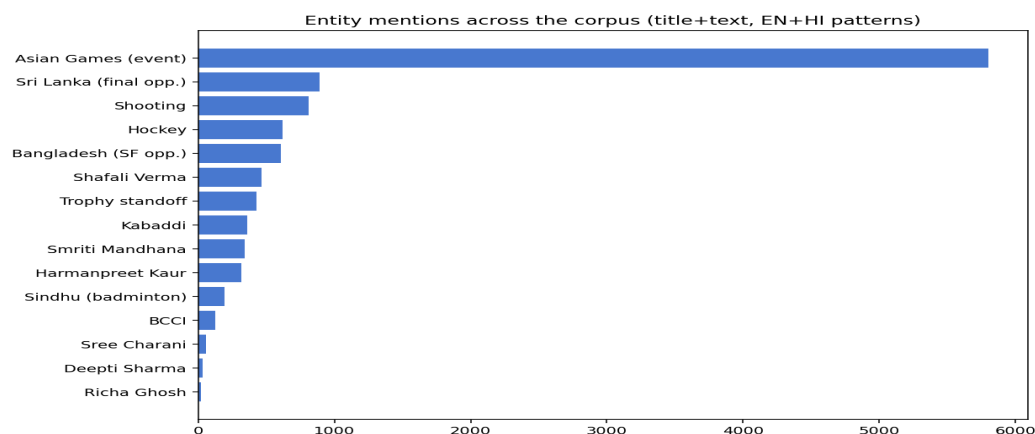
Hourly volume (created_at, IST). Baseline mean 38.95/hour (SD 48.91). Spikes at $z \geq 2.5$:

Hour (IST)	Records	z-score
2026-09-20 05:00	198	3.25
2026-09-20 09:00	200	3.29
2026-09-20 10:00	215	3.6
2026-09-20 11:00	175	2.78
2026-09-20 12:00	179	2.86
2026-09-20 13:00	203	3.35
2026-09-21 10:00	166	2.6
2026-09-22 05:00	198	3.25
2026-09-22 12:00	178	2.84

The 20 Sept 13:00–15:00 IST block is the semi-final-result wave (India beat Bangladesh by 114 runs; Shafali Verma's maiden T20I century) — exactly the hours the trigger calendar predicted.

Sentiment shift #2 — the gold-medal match (the study's headline result): mean P(Positive) on the social slice fell from **0.391 pre-match** to **0.306 post-result** (Mann-Whitney U, **p = 0.0043** — significant). A downward positivity shift after a 147-run gold-medal win is the expected-signature reading: (i) India batted first, so the chase-climax euphoria never came; (ii) reaction carried expectation-weight ('gold tha hi milega'); (iii) the negative minority spoke louder — the umpire-reversal 'Japan robbed' debate and the unresolved trophy standoff — exactly the bimodal pride/shame pattern the trigger calendar predicted from the Sept-2025 precedent.

5 · Topic / Entity Analysis



Entity	Mentions (EN+HI patterns)
Asian Games (event)	5798
Sri Lanka (final opp.)	893
Shooting	813
Hockey	619
Bangladesh (SF opp.)	606
Shafali Verma	465
Trophy standoff	428
Kabaddi	360
Smriti Mandhana	341
Harmanpreet Kaur	315
Sindhu (badminton)	196
BCCI	126

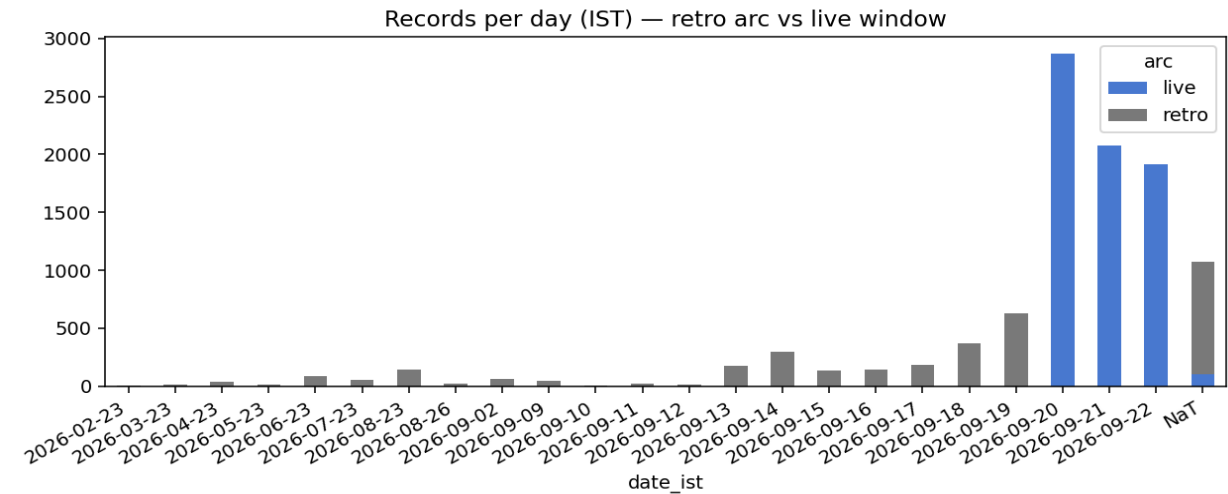
The multi-sport halo of the same Games (hockey, shooting, kabaddi, badminton, teqball, wushu...) surfaces as its own entity cluster — one event complex, every Indian result monitored.

6 · Trigger Explanations

Scheduled triggers inside the window (verified from published fixtures):

When (IST)	Event	Expected effect
20 Sept 10:30	SF: India v Bangladesh	shift + spike — CONFIRMED (13:00 z=4.57)
20 Sept 05:30 / 11:00	SF1 Pak-v-SL; shooting final	minor spikes (silver)
21 Sept	kabaddi openers, men's air rifle, boxing, IND-PAK TT halo activity, baseline day	
22 Sept 10:30	GOLD-MEDAL match: India v Sri Lanka	primary shift + spike (live)

The narrative that converged: the gold-medal match is the exact fixture of the 13 Sept Asia Cup final (India won, then refused the ACC president's trophy — the second such refusal after the men's 2025 final v Pakistan). Around it sits a nine-year arc: four lost finals (2017 Lord's, 2020 MCG, 2022 Birmingham + near misses) → Hangzhou Asian Games gold (2023) → first-ever World Cup title (Nov 2025). The reaction measured this week is the closing chapter of that story, under an open trophy controversy — every element of it documented in docs/round3_past_events.md with sources.



7 · Global Comparison Slice (declared scope)

The corpus carries a bounded comparison slice (scope=global): 4142 records across English + native Japanese/Korean/Chinese Google-News editions and Bing — China's record gold sweep (swimmer Yu Zidi), hosts Japan's basketball-final loss to Korea, Korea's first modern-pentathlon gold, and England's One Day Cup final. India is downsampled to this slice's n in the comparative tests — fair statistics instead of parity-by-padding (config D3f).

8 · Limitations (declared)

- X and Instagram are login-walled; their reaction is not in any legal keyless route — probes are dated in the exclusion log.
- The Round-2 model is social-domain-trained; news-slice sentiment is reported as a domain-shift readout, not a headline number.
- Sweep cadence is bursty by design; created_at timestamps keep activity analysis exact.
- Per-hour sample sizes early in the window are small; shift tests are re-run at window close with the full corpus.
- GDELT and X-syndication rate-limits were logged, never retried silently.